

# Pre-Flight Checks

Your first conversation with AI, set up safely and privately

## — WHAT AI ACTUALLY IS

An AI chat tool is a very well-read assistant that is extremely good at predicting what words should come next, so it can talk with you, draft things for you, and explain things to you. It is not science fiction, it is not always right, and it is not Google.

**The one rule:** shape things with it (words, plans, ideas). Verify anything it presents as a fact before you rely on it.

## — WHEN TO REACH FOR IT, WHEN TO LEAVE IT ALONE

### Does well

Drafting and rewording: emails, letters, posts, summaries

Explaining things simply: 'explain this like I'm new to it'

Organising and brainstorming: lists, plans, options, first drafts

### Does badly

Hard facts, figures, dates and quotes: it can invent them

Anything needing the very latest news

Maths, counting, and your private personal records

## — SIGN UP SAFELY: RED FLAGS

- It asks for a credit card just to chat for free. The major tools don't.
- It arrived as a link in a text, email or ad. Type the address yourself.
- The web address is slightly misspelt or has odd extra words. Close it.

**Never share:** passwords, full bank or card numbers, tax file, Medicare or passport numbers, or other people's private details.

## — TURN TRAINING OFF (ONE-TIME JOB)

1. Open Settings: your name, initial or the gear icon.
2. Find 'Data controls' or 'Privacy'.
3. Switch OFF 'Improve the model' or 'use my data for training'.
4. Find where to delete conversations, for later.
5. Close settings. Your chats stay yours; the tool works the same.

## ✈️ CLEARED TO TRY

**Sign up to one tool** (Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini or Copilot), **say hello**, and **ask it three things about itself**. No grade, no wrong answer. The only goal is to send a message and read a reply.